

Top 9 Strategic Visions to Help CHROs Prepare for 2030

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Initiatives: Strengthen Culture to Power Performance; Technologies and Markets

Emerging technological and nontechnological forces will redefine the trajectory of every organization. Top performing CHROs won't just adapt, they'll shape the future by anticipating change. This research challenges CHRO's to question their perceptions and take proactive steps to prepare for 2030.

Overview

Opportunities

- **Strategic Use of Agentic AI:** HR applications will evolve into dynamic agent-based ecosystems, automating end-to-end processes and enabling seamless human-machine collaboration.
- **Evolving Workforce Dynamics:** Soft skills will eclipse tenure as a primary talent differentiator. Employees will increasingly demand work arrangements tailored to their individual needs.
- **Navigating External Pressures:** Escalating external factors such as conflicting societal values, legal well-being, climate change and blurred work-life boundaries are exposing gaps in current wellness and flexibility offerings.

Recommendations

- Upskill HR teams in AI and talent analytics to ensure HR can architect AI-augmented workflows, govern AI solutions and create value in a hybrid intelligence environment. Pilot a single agentic AI solution for a specific employee workflow.
- Pilot flexible, personalized employment models to address diverse employee needs. Identify where collaboration is essential and ensure that these flexible models still foster shared experiences to help drive teamwork on organizational goals and strengthen employees' sense of connection.
- Adapt global HR strategies to local cultural, legal and societal contexts by involving local experts and employees to ensure policies are inclusive and contextually relevant. Foster open dialogue on emerging health risks, particularly those linked to climate change and litigation, and implement comprehensive well-being initiatives that include mental health resources and resilience education for both employees and managers.

What You Need to Know

This research offers a forward-looking and intentionally thought-provoking outlook on significant disruptions expected to impact HR by the year 2030.

To help you identify the most impactful visions influencing the future, we anchored on Gartner's TPESTRE framework. TPESTRE provides a structured approach to analyzing forces and trends. It focuses on their interconnectedness across seven categories: technological, political, economic, social/cultural, trust/ethics, regulatory/legal and environmental (TPESTRE). For each category, we identified at least one transformative force and crafted a future vision reflecting its potential impact. We then synthesized the interconnected visions into overarching three themes (see Figure 1 for the technology example):

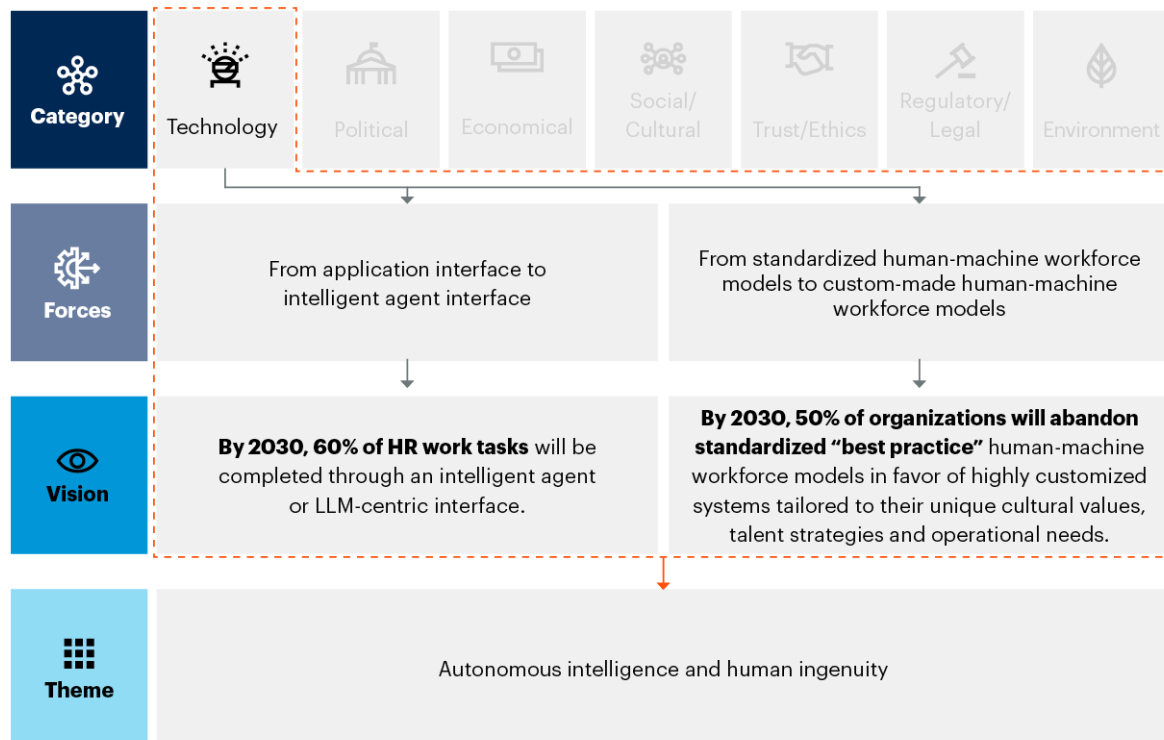
1. Personalized and dynamic employee landscape
2. Autonomous intelligence and human ingenuity
3. Climate crisis

[Download the complete TPESTRE](#)

Figure 1: TPESTRE Trends, Forces, Visions and HR 2030 Themes

TPESTRE^a Trends, Forces, Visions and HR 2030 Themes

Technology Focus Illustrative Example



Source: Gartner

Note: This example illustrates only the Technology section of the complete TPESTRE table to demonstrate the flow from Category to Forces, Vision and Theme; LLM = Large language model

^a TPESTRE = Technology, Political, Economical, Social/Cultural, Trust/Ethics, Regulatory/Legal, Environment

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Personalized and Dynamic Employee Landscape

These visions address the changing relationship between employees and organizations. As AI reduces time to competence, the demand and cost premium for soft skills will rise, changing labor cost equations. This could drive more personalized work arrangements, forcing organizations to move away from standardized employment contracts. This shift is projected to increase diverse cultural values across globally dispersed teams, prompting organizations to consider region-specific value frameworks while still supporting a unified corporate mission. Alongside these shifts is the rise of litigious employee well-being, driven by increasing tribunals and hidden health risks in future work projections, and requiring HR to adopt proactive measures like enforcing mental welfare breaks to mitigate legal exposure.

Autonomous Intelligence and Human Ingenuity

By 2030, application-centric interfaces will be replaced by intelligent agent-centric interfaces. These agents will blur the boundaries between functional applications, giving all employees (including HR) a single agent interface for most work tasks. This will allow HR to move from a transaction shop to a hyperspecialized center of excellence (COE). This agentic shift will also open the door for progressive organizations to move from standard human-tech workflows to custom-made AI-supercharged human-tech workflows. Simultaneously, regulatory trends will demand individual employee data wallets, allowing employees to retain intellectual property as they change employers. A key challenge across this theme is the need for comprehensive ethical technology management, due to increasing regulations and stakeholder demands.

In this quickly evolving landscape, HR will emerge as the architect of human-AI collaboration, serving as strategic stewards who curate a supportive and productive culture of change, champion ethical AI adoption, and ensure that technological advancement amplifies rather than replaces human potential.

Climate Crisis

This vision requires HR to consider the rising cost and disruption caused by climate change into strategic workforce planning. By 2030, the impacts of climate change and the increasing frequency of natural disasters will force HR to become more proactive in planning around these conditions. All organizations may face extreme weather events at some point and should consider strategies such as adapting their operations, migrating to more temperate regions and safeguarding their people to ensure ongoing continuity.

This research offers a description, impact and action section for each vision to help CHROs understand what they can start doing to prepare their organization for 2030.

From Application Interface to Intelligent Agent Interface

Analysis by Travis Wickesberg

SPA: By 2030, 60% of HR work tasks will be completed through an intelligent agent or LLM centric interface.

Description: Traditional application interfaces require users to learn specific workflows, navigate menus, and complete their work within an application's constraints. The emerging large language model (LLM) paradigm fundamentally inverts this relationship. This shift from command-based (step-by-step) to intent-based (define desired outcome) interaction will represent one of the most significant changes in computing history.

Why Trending:

- ChatGPT visits reached over 4 billion users in the first 28 days of March 2025 for the first time, according to a market research firm. ¹
- Fast technological advancements in generative AI (GenAI) models, and agentic AI capabilities are already transforming user interfaces (UIs) in many HR technology applications.

Implications: HR will evolve from application-centric to agent-centric experiences, replacing manual interactions with natural language conversations. These intelligent systems will handle end-to-end processes including recruitment, onboarding, performance reviews and shared services, enabling HR leaders to shift from managing applications to overseeing automated workflows. Intervention will only be needed for exceptions or strategic decisions. Crucially, HR processes will integrate with other functions by designing systems around the job to be done from an employee/manager perspective, not process ownership. HR moves to a COE model with deep expertise in strategic services across all subfunctions, where each HR expert operates alongside a fine-tuned intelligent interface.

Actions: Complete an AI readiness matrix across HR. Catalog HR processes, map data flows and manual touchpoints. Rate each process across dimensions like technical feasibility, workforce disruption and risk exposure. Next, investigate agentic AI capabilities within your existing HR tech stack to see if there's synergy to experiment and learn. Start your journey by experimenting with a single AI agent for a single workflow, as opposed to more complex multiagent systems.

Further Reading: [Emerging Tech: Agentic AI Is Transforming User Interfaces and Experiences](#)

From Standardized Human-Machine Workforce Models to Custom-Made Human-Machine Workforce Models

Analysis by Travis Wickesberg and Piers Hudson

SPA: By 2030, 50% of organizations will abandon standardized “best practice” human-machine workforce models in favor of highly customized systems tailored to their unique cultural values, talent strategies and operational needs.

Description: Progressive organizations will increasingly reject “one-size-fits-all” human-tech workforce strategies in favor of custom-made AI models programmed with operational DNA. This shift reflects the recognition that optimal human-AI collaboration requires deeper integration with organizational culture, talent ecosystems, strategic objectives and their human counterparts’ skills rather than generic implementations.

Why Trending:

- Early findings indicate that the productivity gains from GenAI depend on more than just selecting the right tasks to augment. It is also essential to consider how the experience level of the person performing the task interacts with the complexity of the task or role. This relationship plays a critical role in determining where GenAI can be effectively implemented.
- Forty-four percent of HR leaders who participated in a May 2025 Gartner webinar stated that their HR function planned to primarily use semiautonomous AI agent capabilities within the next 12 months. ²

Implications: HR will be responsible for designing and orchestrating a blend of human and machine roles (ex. subordinate, supervisor, or teammate). To support this, they will invest in a new HR AI agent solution that measures innovative human/machine performance metrics like joint human-machine output quality, innovation velocity, and collaboration effectiveness. Specialized agents and human workforce strategists will monitor and analyze these new data streams to determine where human expertise (critical thinking, creativity, etc.) or where automated workflows via agents deliver the greatest value.

Actions: Human-machine workforce modeling will require meticulous workforce analysis, with strategic workforce planning leaders partnering closely with the CIO and CTO to define the respective roles of AI and employees. Direct your HR team, in partnership with your technology team, to develop tailored AI literacy programs for different personas within the HR function. This will help scale AI understanding and adoption across HR. Also, identify the core capabilities that set the organization apart from competitors. For these differentiating areas, ensure that critical human expertise is preserved as AI is introduced, or explore how AI systems can further enhance and augment these unique strengths.

Further Reading: [Agentic AI Benchmarks Across the Enterprise and HR](#) and [Improve Productivity by Driving Adoption of HR Automation Technologies](#)

From Common Organizational Value Sets to Self-Selected Value Regimes

Analysis by CV Viveritro

SPA: By 2030, 40% of global organizations will implement region or team-specific value frameworks that align with local cultural contexts while maintaining a unified corporate vision.

Description: As more globally dispersed, AI-driven work models and project-based team structures emerge, the increase in microcultures becomes more inevitable and organizations will find it harder to manage a single set of organizational values (i.e., collaboration, innovation, customer-centricity). Instead, HR will play a key role in aligning teams around locally relevant value sets, with some organizations allowing employees to opt into teams that share their preferred values where feasible. The primary intent is to support a more tailored local execution of business objectives while remaining connected to the overall corporate mission.

Why Trending:

- Globally dispersed teams demand the need to be inclusive of diverse cultural values, including local and regional differences.
- Organizations are increasingly focused on localizing culture strategies to increase relatability and relevance for different functions, thus paving the way for region-specific value frameworks to emerge.
- AI-driven and global work models are reducing broadly shared experiences and increasing the diversity of working styles, making localized or team-specific values more practical and effective for driving business outcomes.

Implications: Localized HR value alignment taskforces will be responsible for developing and implementing personalized value sets that still support a unified global mission. HR will need to establish mechanisms to maintain organizational cohesion amid increasing customization. This involves greater investment in technology platforms that facilitate global collaboration across distinct value sets and ways of working. AI-powered tools can help match employees to teams with compatible values and surface emerging value misalignments before they become disruptive, ensuring that local adaptations still support business outcomes. Cross-regional leadership forums or common purpose-building activities for leaders will ensure that values sets — while unique — remain aimed toward a common objective. HR leaders can also leverage AI to create a values map that shows points of overlap, differences and connection to the overall mission.

Actions: Establish regional cultural strategy taskforces to identify relevant local values that will be integrated into local culture and HR practices. Ensure the taskforces demonstrate how local value sets, while distinct from one another, remain aligned to the overall mission using structured mapping and regular review to ensure alignment and support business strategy.

Further Reading: [Define Cultural Values Using Co-creation](#)

From Skills to Adaptable Competencies as a Labor Cost Differentiator

Analysis by Rania Stewart

SPA: By 2030, 50% of the in-demand attributes attracting a compensation premium for experienced professionals will be emergent competencies to lead organizations through volatility including comfort with ambiguity, critical thinking, creativity and problem solving.

Description: As AI begins to replace the need for as many years of past experience for professional roles — or at least speed-to-competence is shortened by AI tools — the premium cost for skills expertise (what they know) begins to decline. Instead, specific competencies (how they apply what they know/navigate the unknown to learn) will attract the compensation premium. *Note: Definitions for a skill vs. competency varies widely in the marketplace and can be inadvertently used interchangeably. It is key to discern these softer skills as behaviorally-based competencies.*

Why Trending:

- The labor market is increasingly valuing skills over traditional credentials. Companies are moving toward skills-based hiring and compensation, prioritizing adaptable, cross-functional and creative skill sets that enable innovation and problem-solving in unpredictable environments.
- As traditional career paths become less relevant, professionals who can develop and propagate emergent skills—especially those that help organizations thrive amid volatility—will command higher compensation than their comparable counterparts.

Implications: HR will need to invest in coaching and new skill based frameworks that blend advanced analytics with human-centric evaluation methods to ensure that soft skills and competencies are measured objectively while preserving the irreplaceable value of interpersonal connection. Advanced AI algorithms will be used to mitigate bias and analyze candidates' communication patterns, decision-making ability and past project outcomes to assess critical thinking and problem solving.

Actions: Get ahead of this curve by ensuring your evolving skills strategy is inclusive of skills (*what* they know/can do) as well as competencies (*how* they behaviorally approach the *what*). In hiring/internal mobility assessments, consider applicant screening technologies like AI-enabled competency-based assessments to complement skills-to-job assessments — in many cases these will include real-time problem solving exercises. Similarly, look to prioritize development in AI coaching, nudgetech or other investments that help promote these softer skills.

From Standard Employment Contracts to Individualized Employment Contracts

Analysis by CV Viverito

SPA: By 2030, 50% of organizations will implement dynamic employment contracts tailored to individual employee needs, preferences and expectations, moving away from one-size-fits-all employment models.

Description: As organizations increasingly incorporate AI-powered tools that change the way we work, short-term work packages and project-based teams, traditional employment models become less useful. Individualized contracts emerge as a strategic response to changing business realities, with employee preferences for flexibility reinforcing the shift.

Why Trending:

- The increase in gig and freelance work is exposing the limitations of uniform employment contracts and creating more of a business demand for individualized work arrangements, setting a precedent for personalized employment contracts. This shift also introduces greater cost base agility, allowing organizations to better align workforce expenses with changing business needs.
- Employees are increasingly seeking flexibility and autonomy, expecting employment terms that reflect their individual circumstances, needs and aspirations.

Implications: The move toward individualized employment contracts will transform HR's role from administrator to architect of flexible employment systems. Rather than negotiating each contract manually, HR will create and manage platforms that allow managers — and to some extent employees — to customize contract elements such as hours, benefits or compensation. In this model, AI-powered scenario analysis helps to determine how much flexibility can be offered, and in which areas, to attract the best talent — enabling a more targeted and dynamic approach than traditional market compensation benchmarking. HR will remain responsible for defining organizational parameters for customization, ensuring equity, and recalibrating policies and practices as business and employee needs continue to evolve.

Actions: Start by identifying where current employment models are not meeting business needs and/or where new models are emerging. Next, audit existing contract terms to gather data on business requirements and employee preferences to identify opportunities for meaningful customization — like flexible schedules, compensation options or tailored benefits. Pilot a platform-based approach to individualized contracts in select business units, using AI to support scenario planning and streamlining customization. Throughout the pilot, gather feedback on perceived fairness and business impact, and use these insights to refine the approach moving forward and set clear equity boundaries for contract differentiation.

From Case-by-Case to an Embedded Framework for Technology Ethics

Analysis by Rania Stewart

SPA: By 2030, 75% of organizations will evolve from piecemeal evaluation of technology ethics to a ubiquitous framework for ethical management of technology, both new and legacy.

Description: As technology becomes deeply embedded across all business units, ethical risks and considerations (e.g., data privacy, algorithmic bias, cybersecurity, transparency) are no longer isolated to new deployments. Instead, they span the entire technology ecosystem, including legacy systems. This complexity requires organizations to shift from piecemeal, case-by-case ethical reviews to holistic frameworks that govern the ethical use of both new and existing technologies. These frameworks must allow for auditability and adjustability in associated values, algorithms and training data.

Why Trending:

- Governments and regulators worldwide are enacting stricter, more comprehensive regulations regarding technology ethics, data privacy and digital responsibility (e.g., GDPR, AI Act in EU, CCPA in California, and similar laws emerging globally).
- Stakeholders — customers, investors, and employees — are demanding greater transparency and accountability in how organizations manage technology risks.

Implications: HR will become a central stakeholder in the ethical management of technology, requiring new skills, processes and collaboration to ensure that ethical considerations are proactively managed across all old and new systems. HR will need to play a role in fostering a culture of ethical tech policies, support ongoing ethics training, update job roles to recruit for ethics expertise, participate in incident responses to protect employer brand and address employee data ethics and transparency at large.

Actions: Pull together a committee or project team to focus on HR proactive/reactive interventions in cooperation with IT and legal liaisons because of its potential devastating brand management implications (both customer and employer). Include recommendations in the team's charter for ethical technology policy development, new training and change management responsibilities, talent management and job architecture implications, as well as compliance/risk/reputation management (incident response).

Further Reading: [Simplifying AI Regulatory Compliance — A Unified Approach for a Fragmented Landscape](#)

From Paternalistic Employee Well-Being to Litigious Employee Well-Being

Analysis by Sam Grinter

SPA: By 2030, 40% of organizations will enforce mental welfare breaks for office workers as a means of reducing their legal exposure for health risks.

Description: The combination of greater data tracking and worker exposure to more hidden health risks in their work (mental and physical) requires organizations to take a more proactive approach to employee well-being or see themselves liable for the unhealthy work employees experience. This shift marks a move from a benevolent, optional focus on well-being to a necessary, risk-managed, litigious responsibility for employers.

Why Trending:

- Increased instances of employment tribunals related to employee well-being and working conditions. ³
- Emergence of a new certification based on a minimum standard of employee well-being as a means of recognizing high-performing organizations, similar to Certified B Corporation.

Implications: HR must introduce processes like employee monitoring and sensing systems (wearables) to gauge risk of poor mental health, and once a threshold is reached, trigger a workflow to put the employee on a mental welfare break. Workflows would also be needed to capture employee consent and attestation, possibly as a condition of employment. Also, HR has the option of feeding this data through to the benefits administration system, which may influence employer health insurance costs. This path would bring in the total rewards leader as a stakeholder in employee mental health.

Actions: Partner with well-being and legal experts to ensure the mental well-being of employees, and to reduce legal exposure and responsibility of the employer. Employee well-being has a new business case, and it's saving the employer money from lawsuits relating to mental distress caused by working conditions. A radical shift in attitude to mental health is required to deliver true well-being for employees as well as safeguard the organization from legal action and reputational risk.

Further Reading: [Well-Being Offerings That Matter Most to Employees](#)

From Organizational Intellectual Property to Individual Intellectual Property Rights

Analysis by Rania Stewart

SPA: By 2030, a regulatory basis will allow individual employee data wallets to retain their portfolio of intellectual property (i.e., their unique data contributions to an organization's knowledge pool) as they transition from company to company.

Description: As data portability regulations (e.g., GDPR, CCPA) mature and expand, they are likely to broaden the definition of personal data to include not just basic identifiers but also intellectual contributions and work-related data. This paves the way for regulatory frameworks that support employee-owned data wallets, enabling professionals to retain and transfer their unique contributions (such as code, research or process improvements) as part of their intellectual portfolio when changing employers.

Why Trending:

- As regulators respond to the changing nature of work and nontraditional employment models, there is a clear move toward empowering employees with more control over their professional data/IP. The trend away from noncompete agreements in the U.S. further supports this movement.
- The rise of decentralized digital credentials is prompting regulators to consider new standards (such as W3C's Decentralized Identifiers and Open Badges) for individual ownership and portability of work-related achievements and contributions.

Implications: HR will become even more tech-savvy and legally astute, evolving from traditional custodians of company data to facilitators of employee empowerment and IP mobility. This shift could fundamentally change the employer-employee relationship, making it more collaborative and transparent, but also more complex in terms of data management and legal compliance.

Actions: Consider this a vision to prepare for, one that allows you to gain a competitive advantage. The key question to ask is: Which roles across the organization are critical (and challenged) to attracting high-value talent, where the prospect of those workers owning their contributions becomes a compelling differentiator to gain employment? For these roles assess the value (ROI) and the cost for these employees to retain their intellectual property. Pursue accordingly with legal/compliance and IT guidance.

From Infrastructure Cost to Climate Change Cost

Analysis by Sam Grinter

SPA: From 2030 onward, climate change cost will be used as a key strategic workforce planning dimension.

Description: The impacts of climate change and the increasing frequency of natural disasters will force HR to become more proactive in planning around these conditions. The potential impact of climate change in different locations will shape where organizations choose to operate and to employ people. This drives climate change costs as a metric in workforce planning decisions.

Why Trending:

- Rising average temperature of 1.5C/2.7F above preindustrial levels. ⁴
- Increased instances of extreme weather events, including fires, hurricanes, flooding and drought.

Implications: The rising cost and disruption caused by climate change will lead to accelerated migration toward temperate regions. HR must navigate this migration to ensure business continuity. This will mean physical redeployment and relocation of large numbers of employees. For those that stay in increasingly hostile locations, offices will take on a new role as emergency bunker and support for employees and their families. HR will also spend increasing amounts on technology and processes to support employees during extreme weather events including, for example, emergency notification systems.

Actions: Convince employees to relocate to environmentally safe locations or make adequate provisions for those who must remain in hazardous areas, but also carefully consider the associated costs. You will play a pivotal role in ensuring business continuity and employee safety as organizations navigate the challenges of environmental hazards. Establish and maintain a minimum standard of life for employees working in challenging environments, with the clear understanding that relocation will be offered if conditions become untenable.

Foster corporate harmony by addressing potential disparities between teams, for example when some employees face direct climate change impacts, while others in safe, but more polluting, locations may be perceived as doing the bare minimum to reduce their carbon footprint. Ultimately, you may need to go beyond governmental minimums, prioritizing transparent communication, equitable standards and proactive cultural alignment to ensure well-functioning global teams.

Further Reading: [Climate Change Protection Becomes the New In-Demand Employee Benefit: Act Now to Prepare for the Future of Work](#)

Evidence

This research is based on client inquiry, vendor briefings and industry trends.

¹ [Similarweb](#), (via X)

² [Benchmark With Gartner: Mitigating Talent Strategy Risk Amid U.S. Policy Shifts & Tackling Skill Gaps](#)

³ [Latest Employment Tribunal Statistics: Claims Are on the Rise](#), Brodies.

⁴ [Temperatures 1.5c Above Pre-Industrial Era Average for 12 Months, Data Shows](#), The Guardian.

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